

00 — FINAL 24 HOURS

Exam: 12 August 2026. Read this file, then only files 05 and 06.

The rule for today: **do not learn anything new**. With one day left, a half-known topic is worse than a skipped one — it creates confident wrong answers. Consolidate what you already have and drill the distinctions.

The plan

Today — roughly 6 hours of real work, then stop

Block	Do	Why
90 min	05-Decision-Tables.md , all of it. Cover the right column, answer aloud, uncover.	This is the exam's actual format. Highest return per minute today.
60 min	Official practice assessment	Calibration. Take it under time.
45 min	Review only what you missed. Look each one up in files 01–04, read that section, close it.	Targeted repair, not re-reading.
45 min	06-Exam-Traps.md §2 (ten traps) and §4 (terminology pairs)	These are where marks leak.
30 min	07-KQL-Cheatsheet.md §3 (tables) only. Skip the rest.	Most KQL questions are really "which table".

30 min	The Core 40 below. Say answers out loud.	
Then	Stop. Eat, walk, sleep 7–8 hours.	Sleep consolidates memory. Cramming past this point trades recall for exhaustion.

Do not take a second practice test late tonight. A bad score at 11pm costs you more in confidence than it gains in knowledge.

Tomorrow morning — 30 minutes maximum

The Core 40 below, and §5 of [06-Exam-Traps.md](#). Nothing else. Close the laptop an hour before you travel.

If you only have 2 hours, not 6

File 05 → the Core 40 → file 06 §2. In that order. Skip the practice test.

The Core 40

Weighted to the real exam split. Cover the right side and recite.

Defender for Cloud + Sentinel — 30–35% (know these cold)

#	Prompt	Answer
1	What drives Secure Score?	The MCSB initiative's recommendations. A control scores only when all its resources are healthy

2	Free vs paid CSPM	Foundational = score, recommendations, MCSB. Defender CSPM = attack paths, cloud security explorer, agentless scanning, governance rules, data-aware posture
3	Defender for Servers P2 only	JIT, FIM , agentless vulnerability/malware/secrets scanning, MDVM premium, network map, DNS alerts, 500 MB/day free ingestion
4	Which agent does Defender for Servers use?	None for most features — agentless + Defender for Endpoint . AMA only for the 500 MB benefit
5	Assign an owner + deadline to a recommendation	Governance rules (Defender CSPM)
6	Stop a recommendation counting, with a documented reason	Exemption — Waiver or Mitigated
7	Make sure a misconfiguration can't recur	Enforce (DINE policy) or Deny (Deny policy) from the recommendation
8	Send alerts to Splunk / QRadar	Continuous export → Event Hub
9	Run a Logic App on a Defender recommendation	Workflow automation
10	Run something on a Sentinel incident	Automation rule (which may call a playbook)
11	Automation rule vs playbook	Rule = Sentinel-native, ordered, can close/assign/re-severity. Playbook = Logic App doing the external action
12	Sentinel rule that runs every minute	NRT

13	Sentinel rule that produces no alerts	Anomaly — writes to the <code>Anomalies</code> table
14	Correlate low-fidelity alerts across products	Fusion (on by default, not customisable, one instance)
15	What breaks the investigation graph?	Missing entity mapping on the analytics rule
16	Ingest CEF from an appliance	AMA + DCR via a Linux log forwarder
17	Windows security events into the workspace	Windows Security Events connector → AMA + Data Collection Rule
18	Azure resource logs vs VM guest telemetry	Diagnostic settings vs DCR
19	Policy effect that blocks creation	Deny
20	The two effects needing a managed identity	DeployIfNotExists and Modify
21	Fix existing non-compliant resources	Remediation task (Deny/Modify alone only affect new/updated)
22	Key Vault soft delete	7–90 days , default 90, cannot be disabled
23	Purge protection	Irreversible once enabled
24	Which KV role reads a secret's value ?	Key Vault Secrets User . <i>Reader cannot</i>
25	KV Premium vs Managed HSM	FIPS 140-2 Level 2 vs Level 3
26	Backups safe from a compromised admin	Multi-user authorization + Resource Guard , plus immutable vault

Networking — 20–25%

#	Prompt	Answer
27	NSG defaults	Inbound internet denied , outbound internet allowed , VNet-to-VNet allowed (incl. peered)
28	Azure Firewall rule order	DNAT → Network → Application
29	Firewall Premium only	TLS inspection, IDPS, URL filtering
30	Filter outbound by FQDN	Firewall application rule (NSG can't)
31	Private Endpoint vs Service Endpoint	PE = private IP , per-resource, works from on-prem , needs privatelink.* DNS zone , costs money. SE = free, subnet-scoped, not from on-prem
32	PE deployed but traffic still goes public	Missing Private DNS zone
33	Rule app teams cannot override	AVNM security admin rule (Deny) — evaluated before NSGs
34	P2S VPN with Entra ID auth	OpenVPN only
35	Encrypt a provider ExpressRoute circuit	IPsec via VPN Gateway over private peering (MACsec needs ExpressRoute Direct)
36	Is VNet peering transitive?	No
37	Route precedence	UDR → BGP → System , then longest prefix
38	WAF false positive	Exclusion — not disabling the rule. And Detection mode before Prevention

Compute / Storage / DB — 20–25%

#	Prompt	Answer
39	Encrypt temp disk + cache , no VM CPU cost	Encryption at host (ADE = guest BitLocker/dm-crypt, needs <code>EnabledForDiskEncryption</code>)
40	Protect data from DBAs	Always Encrypted . TDE = at rest only. DDM masks display, encrypts nothing

Identity — 15–20% (five more, don't skip)

- Global Admin sees no subscriptions → **elevate access** to root scope /
- **PIM = P2, Conditional Access = P1**, security defaults and CA are **mutually exclusive**
- **Sign-in risk** → **MFA**; **user risk** → **password change**
- **Application permissions** always need admin consent; delegated act as the user
- **System-assigned** MI dies with the resource; **user-assigned** is shared across many

The five most revocable/irreversible facts (frequently tested together)

- Revocable SAS → **stored access policy**
- Most secure SAS → **user delegation SAS** (Entra-signed, blob only, **7 days max**)
- **Locked** time-based retention → extend up to **5 times**, **never shorten**
- **Infrastructure encryption** on storage → **creation time only**
- **Purge protection** and **immutable vault locking** → **irreversible**

Exam-day mechanics

- **Pass mark is 700**, scaled — not 70% of questions. Don't try to compute your score mid-exam.
- **Case studies come first** in most Azure exams and are often **one-way** — once you leave a case study section you cannot return. Read the requirements carefully before answering; the constraints ("least privilege", "minimise cost") are in the case text, not the question.
- **Mark for review** anything you're unsure of and move on. Time pressure causes more failures than knowledge gaps.
- **Never leave a question blank** — no negative marking.
- On yes/no repeated-scenario items ("Does this meet the goal?"), each is scored **independently** and you cannot go back. The same stem appears 3 times with different solutions; often more than one is correct.
- **Drag-and-drop ordering** questions: think about the actual sequence of operations (create the vault → enable soft delete/purge protection → create the disk encryption set → grant the managed identity → encrypt).
- Arrive early, have ID ready. If it's online-proctored, clear your desk and test the system **tonight**, not tomorrow.

Answering strategy when you don't know

1. **Eliminate the deprecated option.** If a retired feature and its replacement both appear, pick the replacement (see [06-Exam-Traps.md](#) §3).
 2. **Find the constraint word.** "No public IP" → Bastion. "From on-premises" → Private Endpoint. "Cannot be overridden" → AVNM/Policy Deny. "Without storing credentials" → managed identity. Full list in [05-Decision-Tables.md](#) §E.
 3. **Prefer the managed, native, built-in option** unless the stem explicitly rules it out.
 4. **Prefer least privilege** — the narrower scope is usually right.
 5. If two answers both work, the one that matches the **stated constraint** wins, not the one that's more secure in the abstract.
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One last thing

You've built and reviewed notes across the whole outline, weighted correctly, checked against current documentation. That's more preparation than most people walk in with. Trust the decision tables — the exam asks "which one", and that's exactly what you drilled.

Good luck.